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United States Patent	12405137
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Watanabe; Kento

Information processing system, information processing method, recording medium, node device, gateway device, manufacturing system, method of manufacturing product

Abstract

An information processing system includes a plurality of node devices and a gateway device configured to communicate with the plurality of node devices. Each of the plurality of node devices is connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of a facility, and is configured to execute a measurement task. Each of the plurality of node devices is configured to add node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information used to identify the measurement task executed by the node device, to measurement data acquired in the measurement task, and send the measurement data to the gateway device.

Inventors:	Watanabe; Kento (Kanagawa, JP)
Applicant:	CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)
Family ID:	77747803
Assignee:	CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)
Appl. No.:	18/446722
Filed:	August 09, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240019281 A1	Jan. 18, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2020-050521	Mar. 23, 2020
JP	2020-179431	Oct. 27, 2020

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17188024 20210301 US 11761798 child-doc US 18446722

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G01D5/39** (20060101); **G01D21/00** (20060101); **H04L67/12** (20220101); **H04L67/565** (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G01D5/39** (20130101); **G01D21/00** (20130101); **H04L67/12** (20130101); **H04L67/565** (20220501);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

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Primary Examiner: McCormack; Thomas S

Attorney, Agent or Firm: VENABLE LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates to an information processing system and the like that obtains the state of a production facility by collecting measurement data from sensors attached to the production facility.

Description of the Related Art

(2) In general, it has been difficult to find an abnormal state of a production facility in the maintenance of the production facility even if the production facility is in the abnormal state, as long as the abnormal state does not hinder the operation of the production facility. For this reason, preventive maintenance that needs periodic inspection, repair, and component replacement is performed. However, the preventive maintenance has a problem that involves the regular inspection and its man-hours.

(3) As countermeasures to such a problem, predictive maintenance has been tried in recent years. In the predictive maintenance, sensors are disposed in a production facility, and the component replacement, repair, and update are performed in accordance with the state of the production facility for reducing unnecessary component replacement and labor costs.

(4) In this case, since many sensors are disposed to collect measurement data, detailed diagnosis and early detection of abnormality can be achieved. However, if many sensors are disposed, types of the sensors and types of measurement need to be identified in the collection of measurement data.

(5) For this reason, a diagnosis system that identifies an individual sensor and a type of measurement has already been proposed.

(6) For example, Japanese Patent Application Publication No. 2012-238082 discloses a data collection method. In the data collection method, a data collection device sends ID numbers of measuring devices and the order of collection of measurement data, to all the measuring devices. The measuring devices are devices whose measurement data is required by the data collection device. Each of the measuring devices determines whether the current communication is a communication between the data collection device and a measuring device whose ID number precedes the ID number of the measuring device itself, depending on the order of collection of measurement data; and sends the measurement data to the data collection device at an appropriate timing.

(7) In the conventional method, however, the data collection device has to determine the order of collection in advance for determining the type of measurement data. In addition, the data collection device has to specify measurement conditions, or otherwise the sensors have to send their

measurement conditions to the data collection device. In this case, since the measurement-condition data has to be handled in addition to the measurement data, the amount of data will increase, possibly making it difficult for the wireless-communication band to accommodate the measurement-condition data and the measurement data.

(8) Thus, it has been desired to achieve a method that can recognize a measurement condition of a measurement data even in a limited communication band.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(9) According to a first aspect of the present invention, an information processing system includes a plurality of node devices and a gateway device configured to communicate with the plurality of node devices. Each of the plurality of node devices is connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of a facility, and is configured to execute a measurement task. Each of the plurality of node devices is configured to add node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information used to identify the measurement task executed by the node device, to measurement data acquired in the measurement task, and send the measurement data to the gateway device.

(10) According to a second aspect of the present invention, an information processing method uses an information processing system. The information processing system includes a plurality of node devices and a gateway device configured to communicate with the plurality of node devices. Each of the plurality of node devices is connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of a facility, and is configured to execute a measurement task. The method includes adding, by each of the plurality of node devices, node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information used to identify the measurement task executed by the node device, to measurement data acquired in the measurement task, and sending the measurement data to the gateway device.

(11) According to a third aspect of the present invention, a node device is connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of a facility. The node device is configured to execute a measurement task. The node device is configured to communicate with a gateway device. The node device is configured to add node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information used to identify the measurement task executed by the node device, to measurement data acquired in the measurement task, and send the measurement data to the gateway device.

(12) According to a fourth aspect of the present invention, a gateway device is configured to communicate with a plurality of node devices. Each of the plurality of node devices is connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of a facility, and is configured to execute a measurement task. If the gateway device receives from any one of the plurality of node devices, measurement data to which node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information have been added, the gateway device stores the measurement data to which the node identification information and the task identification information have been added, in a database of an information processing system.

(13) According to a fifth aspect of the present invention, a manufacturing system includes a facility configured to manufacture a product, a plurality of node devices, each of the plurality of node devices being connected to a sensor configured to measure a state of the facility, and being configured to execute a measurement task, and a gateway device configured to communicate with the plurality of node devices. Each of the plurality of node devices is configured to add node identification information used to identify the node device and task identification information used to identify the measurement task executed by the node device, to measurement data acquired in the measurement task, and send the measurement data to the gateway device.

(14) Further features of the present invention will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an information processing system of an embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block configuration diagram of a node device of the embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a block configuration diagram of a gateway device of the embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a task table of the node device of the embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 5 is an index table of the gateway device of the embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating an operating procedure of the node device of the embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating an operating procedure of the gateway device of the embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of an information processing system of a second example.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a block configuration diagram of a node device of the second example.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a task table of the node device of the second example.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of an information processing system of a third example.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a task table of a node device of the third example.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a task table of another node device of the third example.
- (14) FIG. 14 is a schematic diagram of an information processing system of a fourth example.
- (15) FIG. 15 is a task table of a node device of the fourth example.
- (16) FIG. 16 is an index table of a gateway device of the fourth example.
- (17) FIG. 17 is a flowchart illustrating an operating procedure of the gateway device of the fourth example.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

Embodiment

- (18) Hereinafter, an information processing system (facility monitoring system) of an embodiment of the present invention will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings.
- (19) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a production facility to which the information processing system of an embodiment has been applied. The production facility **101** includes sensors **102** and **103** used to obtain the state of the production facility **101**. Each of the sensors **102** and **103** may be a vibration sensor, an acceleration sensor, a pressure sensor, a photosensor, a torque sensor, or a temperature sensor; and measures the state of the production facility **101** and quantifies the state as a physical quantity. Thus, the information processing system obtains the state of the production facility **101** by using the sensors **102** and **103**, and thereby monitors the production facility **101**.
- (20) For obtaining the state of the production facility **101**, a node device **104** is connected with at least one of the sensors **102** and **103**. The sensors **102** and **103** may be included in the node device **104**. The node device **104** is one or more in number, determined as necessary; and is disposed in the production facility **101**. The node device **104** includes communication units **109**, which allow the node device **104** to communicate with a gateway device **105**. The communication units include one or more communication portions, selected appropriately from wireless communications including low power wide area (LPWA) and wireless LAN, and wire communications including the Ethernet and Field Network.
- (21) The measurement data measured by the sensors is collected in the gateway device **105** from the node device **104** via the communication units **109** and **110**. The gateway device **105** is connected with an in-plant network **106**. Note that the in-plant network **106** may be a dedicated network used in a plant (LAN), or may be a wide area network such as the Internet. The gateway device **105** is installed in an area in which the gateway device **105** can communicate with the node device **104** via the communication units **109** and **110**.
- (22) The measurement data collected in the gateway device **105** is stored in a database **107** of a data storage device connected to the in-plant network **106**. Note that the function of the gateway

device **105** may be implemented as software in the database **107** or a storage portion of a computer. In addition, the database **107** may be a storage device or a storage medium.

(23) An administrator can check the resultant data stored in the database **107**, by using a computer **108**. If an abnormal state occurs in the production facility **101**, the computer **108** can notify the administrator of the abnormal state, if necessary. For example, the computer **108** may issue an alert, or send a mail to the administrator.

(24) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating a block configuration of the node device **104** of FIG. 1. The node device **104** is connected with a sensor **203** that is one or more sensors disposed in the production facility **101**. The node device **104** includes a signal input portion (A/D converter) **204**, which converts an analog signal outputted from the sensor **203**, to a digital signal. The signal input portion **204** converts one or more analog input signals to digital signals. Note that the signal input portion **204** may be included in the sensor **203**, and the sensor **203** may output the digital signals.

(25) The signal digitized by the signal input portion **204** is processed by a CPU **205**. The CPU **205** selects one or more of the following processes: no-operation process, FFT process, partial overall process, envelop process, frequency filter process, differential process, integral process, wavelet process, average value process, standard deviation process, maximum value process, minimum value process, peak-to-peak process, peak hold process, effective value process, crest factor process, form factor process, impulse coefficient process, margin coefficient process, and machine-learning-model inference process, determines the order of the selected processes, and executes them.

(26) For example, in the no-operation process, the CPU **205** does not process the digitized input signal, and delivers the digitized signal to an output portion **206**. In the FFT process, the CPU **205** decomposes the digitized input signal into frequency components. In the partial overall process, the CPU **205** determines a frequency range, and sums the FFT-processed frequency components in the determined frequency range. In the envelop process, the CPU **205** determines an envelope of the input signal. In the frequency filter process, the CPU **205** sets a frequency range, and causes the input signal to pass through a low-pass filter, a high-pass filter, or a band-pass filter for eliminating undesired signals and obtaining an intended signal.

(27) In the differential process, the CPU **205** differentiates the input signal. In the integral process, the CPU **205** integrates the input signal. In the wavelet process, the CPU **205** decomposes the digitized input signal into frequency components and time components. In the average value process, the CPU **205** calculates an average value of the input signal. In the standard deviation process, the CPU **205** calculates a standard deviation of the input signal. In the maximum value process, the CPU **205** calculates a maximum value of the input signal. In the minimum value process, the CPU **205** calculates a minimum value of the input signal. In the peak-to-peak process, the CPU **205** calculates a difference between the maximum value and the minimum value of the input signal. In the peak hold process, the CPU **205** measures the input signal continuously in a predetermined period of time, and calculates a maximum value of the input signal in the predetermined period of time. In the effective value process, the CPU **205** calculates an effective value of the input signal.

(28) In the crest factor process, the CPU **205** calculates a crest factor of the input signal by dividing a maximum value of the input signal by an effective value of the input signal. In the form factor process, the CPU **205** calculates a form factor of the input signal by dividing an effective value of the input signal by an average value of the input signal. In the impulse coefficient process, the CPU **205** calculates an impulse coefficient of the input signal by dividing a maximum value of the input signal by an absolute average value of the input signal. In the margin coefficient process, the CPU **205** calculates a margin coefficient of the input signal by dividing a maximum value of the input signal by a value of the input signal. The value is obtained by calculating a square root of an average value of the input signal, and then calculating a square of the square root value. In the machine-learning-model inference process, a computer creates a machine learning model (learned

model) in advance by reading and analyzing learning data. In the machine learning model, rules for classification and identification are defined. The machine learning model is implemented in the node device **104**, and the CPU **205** determines the output depending on the input signal and the machine learning model.

(29) Note that although the above-described various types of signal processing are performed by the CPU **205**, they may be performed by a dedicated piece of hardware such as a PLA.

(30) The node device **104** includes the output portion **206** that outputs a signal processed by the CPU **205**. The output portion **206** operates under the control of the CPU **205**, and includes at least one of a wireless-communication unit **207** and a wire-communication unit **208**. In addition to the wireless-communication unit **207** and/or the wire-communication unit **208**, the output portion **206** can select at least one of a storage portion **209** and a general-purpose input/output portion **211**, and can output measurement data to a selected portion. Specifically, the output portion **206** can add a node number (node identification information) and a measurement task number (task identification information) to measurement data, and output the measurement data. The node number serves as identification information used to identify the node device **104** as an individual device. The output portion **206** uses wireless communications or wire communications, and outputs the node number, the measurement task number, and the measurement data to the gateway device **105** in this order. The wire-communication unit **208** is connected to the gateway device **105** via a sensor network **210**.

(31) The node device **104** includes an event generation portion **202** that is activated at diagnosis intervals or a diagnosis time, which is predetermined as a timer trigger, or is activated by a trigger inputted via the general-purpose input/output portion **211**. The event condition of the event generation portion **202** includes at least one of a predetermined measurement interval, a time, an external-trigger input signal, a change in the state of the node device, a call from another task of the node device, a call from the gateway device, and a call from another node device. If a plurality of event generation conditions is selected, the measurement is started when any one of the selected conditions is satisfied.

(32) The event generation portion **202** may be a dedicated piece of hardware such as a PLA, or may be a piece of software that is a control program for controlling the operation of the CPU **205**.

(33) For example, if the event condition is measurement intervals, events are generated at predetermined intervals. If the event condition is a time, an event is generated, for example, at a predetermined time on a predetermined day of the week. If the event condition is an external-trigger input signal, an event is generated when a signal from the general-purpose input/output portion **211** changes. If the event condition is a change in the state of the node device, an event is generated when the remaining battery level of the node device changes, or when a signal from a temperature sensor of the node device changes. If the event condition is a call from another task of the node device, an event is generated when the event generation portion **202** is called from the other task of the node device under the output condition of the other task. If the event condition is a call from the gateway device, an event is generated when the node device receives a task execution command from the gateway device. If the event condition is a call from another node device, an event is generated when the event generation portion **202** is called from the other node device under the output condition of the other node device.

(34) The event condition of the event generation portion **202**, the signal input condition of the signal input portion **204**, the signal processing condition of the CPU **205**, and the output condition of the output portion **206** are stored, as components of a measurement task, in a task table of the storage portion **209**. Note that although the task table is stored in the storage portion **209**, the task table may be stored in another storage device.

(35) FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram illustrating a block configuration of the gateway device **105** illustrated in FIG. **1**. The gateway device **105** includes a wire-communication unit **304** for communicating via wire with the node device **104**, via a sensor network **303** (**210**). In addition, the

gateway device **105** includes a wireless-communication unit **302** for communicating wirelessly with the node device **104**. The unit that allows the gateway device **105** and the node device **104** to communicate with each other may be the wire-communication unit **304** or the wireless-communication unit **302**, depending on an environment where the node device **104** is installed.

(36) The gateway device **105** includes a CPU **308** that controls the operation of each unit. The gateway device **105** has an index table stored in a storage device **305**. The index table is used to associate measurement data with a corresponding table of the database **107** (FIG. 1) by using a node number and a task number. The node number is used to identify the node device **104** as an individual device. The CPU **308** of the gateway device **105** determines a table of the database **107** in which the measurement data is to be stored, by using the node number of the node device **104**, the measurement task number, and information of the index table. The gateway device **105** receives measurement data from the node device **104** via the wire-communication unit **304** or the wireless-communication unit **302**, and stores the measurement data in a table of the database **107** via an in-plant network **307** (**106**) connected with a wire-communication unit **306**. Note that the sensor network **303** and the in-plant network **307** may be an identical network.

(37) The table illustrated in FIG. 4 is a task table **401** of the node device **104**. The node device **104** has the task table **401**, which is stored in the storage portion **209** as information. The task table **401** includes a task number **402** assigned to a corresponding task, an event condition **403** of the event generation portion **202**, a signal input condition **404** of the signal input portion **204**, a signal processing condition **405** of the CPU **205**, an output processing condition **406** of the output portion **206**, and a node number **407**. In the task table **401** of the node device **104**, one or more measurement tasks are registered in advance, in accordance with measurement items and sensors connected to the node device **104**. The measurement tasks registered in the task table **401** are executed sequentially in the order from a measurement task whose event condition **403** has been satisfied. The task whose event condition **403** has been satisfied is executed under the signal input condition **404**, the signal processing condition **405**, and the output processing condition **406**.

(38) The table illustrated in FIG. 5 is an index table **501** of the gateway device **105**. The gateway device **105** has the index table **501**, which is stored in the storage device **305** as information. The index table **501** includes a node number **502** of the node device **104**, a task number **503** that indicates a number assigned to a corresponding task of the node device **104** registered in the task table **401**, a receiving means **505**, a database name **504** indicating a data storage device where data is to be stored, and a table name **506** that defines an area of the database where the data is to be stored. The index table **501** is registered in advance, associated with the node device **104** connected to the gateway device **105** and with the task table **401** of the node device **104**. Upon receiving measurement data from the node device **104**, the gateway device **105** searches the index table **501** for a node number **502** and a task number **503** included in the received measurement data. The gateway device **105** then registers the measurement data by using the information on the database name **504** and the table name **506** corresponding to the node number **502** and the task number **503** of the index table **501**.

(39) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of processes in which the node device **104** obtains the state of the production facility **101**. The following description will be made for processes in which the state of the production facility **101** is obtained by using the task table.

(40) In Step S1, the CPU **205** of the node device **104** starts to obtain the state of the production facility **101**. In Step S2, the CPU **205** reads tasks that have been registered in advance, from the task table **401** of the storage portion **209**.

(41) In Step S3, the CPU **205** registers an event condition **403** of each task, which is registered in the task table **401**, in the event generation portion **202**.

(42) In Step S4, the CPU **205** of the node device **104** refers to the event registered in Step S3, and checks whether an event, such as a specified time, a specified interval, or an external input, has occurred.

(43) If an event has occurred, then the CPU **205** executes a task corresponding to the event. In Step **S5**, the CPU **205** sets the signal input portion **204** by selecting a signal input condition **404** including a physical-quantity input channel, a sampling frequency, an input range, the number of samples, and an amplification factor, which are registered in the task table **401**.

(44) In Step **S6**, the CPU **205** performs a signal input process, such as analog-digital conversion, under the signal input condition **404** that has been set. In Step **S7**, the CPU **205** selects a signal processing condition **405** registered in the task table **401**, and performs the setting of the CPU **205**. In Step **S8**, the CPU **205** performs signal processing on the digitalized measurement data. In Step **S9**, for handling the signal-processed measurement data, the CPU **205** sets the output portion **206** under an output processing condition **406** registered in the task table **401**.

(45) In Step **S10**, the CPU **205** adds a node number **407** of the node device **104** and a task number **402** corresponding to the event, to the measurement data. Note that if the output condition (output destination) is the storage device, only the task number may be added to the measurement data because the node number is known. In Step **S11**, the measurement data to which the node number and the measurement task number have been added is outputted to the gateway device, the general-purpose input/output portion of the output portion **206**, or the storage device of the output portion **206**, under the output processing condition **406**. When Step **S11** is completed, the CPU **205** returns to Step **S4**, and checks whether an event has occurred again.

(46) FIG. **7** is a flowchart for illustrating a procedure in which the gateway device **105** collects and processes measurement data for obtaining the state of the production facility. The following description will be made for a procedure in which the gateway device **105** registers the measurement data sent from the node device **104**, in a database for obtaining the state of the production facility.

(47) In Step **S51**, the CPU **308** of the gateway device **105** starts to obtain the state of the production facility **101**. In Step **S52**, the CPU **308** reads the index table **501** that has been registered in advance in the storage device **305**.

(48) In Step **S53**, the CPU **308** of the gateway device **105** selects a receiving unit to receive measurement data from the node device **104**, depending on a receiving means **505** registered in the index table **501**. If a plurality of receiving means are registered in the index table **501**, the gateway device **105** selects a plurality of receiving units.

(49) In Step **S54**, the CPU **308** of the gateway device **105** checks whether one receiving unit has received measurement data from the node device **104**. If the receiving unit receives measurement data from the node device **104**, then the gateway device **105** proceeds to Step **S55**, and extracts a node number of the node device and a task number from the measurement data.

(50) In Step **S56**, the CPU **308** searches the index table **501** for indexes by using the node number and the task number. Then the CPU **308** determines a table of a database where the measurement data is to be stored, depending on the indexes that the CPU **308** has found. In Step **S57**, the CPU **308** creates a query to store the measurement data. In Step **S58**, the CPU **308** of the gateway device **105** executes the query and stores the measurement data in the table of the database. When Step **S58** is completed, the CPU **308** returns to Step **S54**, and checks whether the receiving unit has received measurement data again.

(51) In the present embodiment, since the communication is performed efficiently, the gateway device can easily determine, even in a limited communication band, that one piece of measurement data has been sent from which node device, or measured in which measurement task. In addition, since the communication is performed efficiently, the power consumption of the node device can be reduced.

(52) Next, some specific examples will be described. In a first example, measurement is performed depending on a recipe, and the measurement result is stored in a data storage device. In a second example, in an abnormal state, measurement is performed depending on another recipe. In a third example, in an abnormal state, measurement is performed by another node device, depending on a

recipe of the other node device. In a fourth example, if the gateway device receives measurement data from a node device that is not registered in the index table, the gateway device stores the measurement data in a database, as test data.

FIRST EXAMPLE

(53) The first example of the present embodiment will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a production facility that includes an information processing system of the first example.

(54) A pump serves as the production facility **101**, and includes vibration sensors **102** and **103** for obtaining the operation state. The vibration sensors **102** and **103** convert the strength of vibration to a voltage signal, as a physical quantity. The vibration sensors **102** and **103** are connected to a node device **104**, and obtain the state of the pump, which serves as the production facility **101**. The node device **104** includes communication units **109**, which allow the node device **104** to communicate with the gateway device **105**. For example, the node device **104** includes an LPWA (low power wide area) wireless-communication unit.

(55) The node device **104** performs measurement, depending on a task table **401** stored in advance in a storage portion **209**. Specifically, the node device **104** performs measurement under an event condition **403**, which is set in the task table **401** of FIG. 4.

(56) In a task 1 in which a task number **402** is 1, since the event condition **403** is set so that events occur at intervals of 60 minutes, the task 1 is executed once every 60 minutes. Specifically, the elapsed time is reset when the power of the node device **104** is turned on, and the task 1 is executed every time 60 minutes has elapsed. When the task 1 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **404**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 50. In the task 1, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU **205** performs the FFT process and then the partial overall process under a signal processing condition **405**. Since wireless communication is selected under an output processing condition **406** for the task 1, the CPU **205** adds the number of the node device **104** and the task number of 1 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to the gateway device **105** via a wireless-communication unit **207**.

(57) In a task 2 in which a task number **402** is 2, the task 2 is executed at 15:00 on every Monday, under an event condition **403**. When the task 2 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **404**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 2; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 50. In the measurement task 2, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU **205** performs the FFT process under a signal processing condition **405**. Since wire communication is selected under an output processing condition **406** for the measurement task 2, the CPU **205** adds the number of the node device **104** and the task number of 2 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to the gateway device **105** via a wire-communication unit **208**.

(58) The gateway device **105** receives measurement data, to which the node number **104** and the task number 1 have been added, from the node device **104** via the wireless-communication unit **302** every time the task 1 is executed at an interval of 60 minutes. The gateway device **105** extracts the number of the node device **104** and the task number of 1 from the measurement data, and searches the index table **501** (FIG. 5) of the storage device **305**.

(59) If the node number is **104** and the task number is 1, the gateway device **105** finds a database name **504** of DB1 and a table name **506** of TBL3, which have been registered in advance in the index table **501**. The gateway device **105** creates a query to store the measurement data in the table TBL3 of the database DB1, and stores the measurement data in the table TBL3 of the database **107** (DB1), via the in-plant network **307**.

(60) Similarly, when the measurement task 2 is executed at 15:00 on every Monday, the gateway

device **105** receives measurement data, to which the node number **104** and the task number **2** have been added, from the node device **104** via the wire-communication unit **304**. The gateway device **105** creates a query to store the measurement data in a table TBL4 of the database **107** (DB1), and stores the measurement data in the table TBL4 of the database **107** (DB1), via the in-plant network **307**.

(61) The node device **104** has a plurality of measurement tasks. Thus, if the gateway device receives only the measurement data, the gateway device cannot distinguish the measurement task from the other measurement tasks. Consequently, the gateway device cannot store the measurement data in a corresponding table of a corresponding database specified for the measurement task. In addition, if the node device **104** specifies a database and a table for storing measurement data, the amount of send data will increase, possibly shortening the battery life of the node device and making it difficult for the communication band to accommodate the send data.

(62) In the present example, since the node number and the task number are added to the measurement data by the node device, the battery life of the node device can be secured, and each measurement data can be identified by the gateway device. In addition, the present example can provide a measuring means that can set a plurality of measurement conditions.

SECOND EXAMPLE

(63) The second example of the present embodiment will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. FIG. **8** is a schematic diagram of an information processing system. The following description will be made for a procedure in which detailed measurement is performed when a blade of a pump of a production facility is damaged for example and abnormal vibration is occurring.

(64) For obtaining the operation state of a pump **801**, a channel 1 of a node device **802** is connected to a vibration sensor **803**, and a channel 2 of the node device **802** is connected to a temperature sensor **804**. In a task table of the node device **802**, a measurement task 1, a measurement task 2, and a measurement task 3 have been registered in advance.

(65) FIG. **9** illustrates a block configuration diagram of the node device, and FIG. **10** illustrates a task table **1001** of the node device.

(66) A node device **802** is connected to the vibration sensor **803** and the temperature sensor **804**, which are illustrated in FIG. **9** as a sensor **903**. The node device **802** includes a signal input portion **904**, which converts an analog signal outputted from the sensor **903**, to a digital signal. That is, the signal input portion **904** converts an analog input signal to a digital signal. Note that the signal input portion **904** may be included in the sensor **903**.

(67) The signal digitized by the signal input portion **904** is processed by a CPU **905**. The CPU **905** selects one or more of the following processes: no-operation process, PH process, partial overall process, envelop process, frequency filter process, differential process, integral process, wavelet process, average value process, standard deviation process, maximum value process, minimum value process, peak-to-peak process, peak hold process, effective value process, crest factor process, form factor process, impulse coefficient process, margin coefficient process, and machine-learning-model inference process, and determines the order of the selected processes.

(68) The node device **802** includes an output portion **906** that outputs a signal processed by the CPU **905**. The output portion **906** includes a threshold determination portion **912**, which selects an output destination depending on a result of a process performed by the CPU **905**. In addition, the output portion **906** includes at least one of a wireless-communication unit **907** and a wire-communication unit **908**. Under the control of the CPU **905**, the output portion **906** selects at least one of the wireless-communication unit **907**, the wire-communication unit **908**, a storage portion **909**, and a general-purpose input/output portion **911**, as an output destination. The CPU **905** associates a result of a process performed by the CPU **905**, with a node number **1007** and a task number **1002** (FIG. **10**), and outputs the result as measurement data. The node number **1007** is a number to identify the node device **802** as an individual device.

(69) The wire-communication unit **908** is connected to a gateway device **851** via a sensor network **910**. The node device **802** includes an event generation portion **902** that is activated at diagnosis intervals or a diagnosis time, which is predetermined as a timer trigger, or is activated by a trigger inputted via the general-purpose input/output portion **911**.

(70) The event condition of the event generation portion **902** is stored, as a component of a measurement task, in a task table of the storage portion **909**, together with the signal input condition of the signal input portion **904**, the signal processing condition of the CPU **905**, and the output condition of the output portion **906**. Note that although the task table is stored in the storage portion **909**, the task table may be stored in another storage device.

(71) A task 1 is executed under an event condition **1003**, once every 60 minutes. When the task 1 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **1004**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 50. In the task 1, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU **905** performs the frequency filter process and then the average value process under a signal processing condition **1005**. In the task 1, wireless communication and conditional measurement tasks 2 and 3 are selected under an output condition **1006**. The CPU **905** adds the node number **802** and the task number 1 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to a gateway device **851** via the wireless-communication unit **907**. The gateway device **851** registers the measurement data, to which the node number **1007 (802)** and the task number **1002 (1)** have been added, in a database **853** via a network **852**.

(72) For example, if a blade **805** of the pump **801** is damaged and abnormal vibration is occurring, an average value of measurement data in the task 1 exceeds 50.0 m/s.sup.2, and the threshold determination portion **912** of the output portion **906** determines that the average value has exceeded the threshold (a predetermined condition has been satisfied). Then, the node device sends the measurement data to the gateway device **851**, and executes the measurement tasks 2 and 3. The node device **802** then sends the result of the measurement tasks 2 and 3, to the gateway device **851** under an output condition **1006**.

(73) In the task 2, detailed measurement is performed by using the vibration sensor. In the measurement task 2, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **1004**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 50. In the measurement task 2, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU **905** performs the FFT process under a signal processing condition **1005**. Since wireless communication is selected under an output condition **1006**, the CPU **905** adds the node number **802** and the task number 2 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to the gateway device **851** via the wireless-communication unit. The gateway device **851** registers the measurement data, to which the node number **1007 (802)** and the task number **1002 (2)** have been added, in the database **853** via the network **852**.

(74) In the measurement task 3, measurement is performed by using the temperature sensor. In the measurement task 3, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **1004**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 2; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 1. In the measurement task 3, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU **905** performs the frequency filter process and then the average value process under a signal processing condition **1005**. Since wireless communication is selected under an output condition **1006**, the CPU **905** adds the node number **802** and the task number 3 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to the gateway device **851** via the wireless-communication unit. The gateway device **851** registers the measurement data, to which the node number **1007 (802)** and the task number **1002 (3)** have been added, in the database **853** via the network **852**.

(75) In the present example, the output portion includes the threshold determination portion, which

selects an output condition depending on a determination result. Thus, the battery life can be secured, and detailed measurement can be performed in accordance with the result of a task, in a limited communication band.

THIRD EXAMPLE

(76) The third example of the present embodiment will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of an information processing system. The following description will be made for a procedure in which when a blade of a pump of a production facility is damaged and abnormal vibration is occurring, a task of another node device is called depending on a measurement result of one node device.

(77) For obtaining the operation state of a pump 1101, a channel 1 of a node device 1102 is connected to a vibration sensor 1104, and a channel 1 of a node device 1103 is connected to a temperature sensor 1105. FIG. 12 illustrates a task table 1201 of the node device 1102. In the task table 1201, a measurement task 1 has been registered in advance. In addition, in a task table 1301 of the node device 1103, a measurement task 1 and a measurement task 2 have been registered in advance. The output portion 906 (FIG. 9) of the node device 1102 includes the threshold determination portion 912.

(78) FIG. 13 illustrates the task table 1301 of the node device 1103. In the task table 1301, the task 1 is set so as to be executed at 15:00 on every Monday under an event condition 1303. In addition, the measurement task 2 is set so as to be executed when called from another node device, under an event condition 1303.

(79) As illustrated in FIG. 12, the task 1 of the node device 1102 is executed under an event condition 1203, once every 60 minutes. When the task 1 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition 1204: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 50. In the task 1, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU 905 (FIG. 9) performs the frequency filter process and then the average value process under a signal processing condition 1205.

(80) In the task 1, wireless communication and conditional call to the measurement task 2 of the node device 1103 are selected under an output condition 1206. The CPU 905 adds a node number 1102 and a task number 1 to the measurement data of the task 1, and sends the measurement data from the node device 1102 to a gateway device 1151 via the wireless-communication unit 907. The gateway device 1151 registers the measurement data, to which the node number 1207 (1102) and the task number 1202 (1) have been added, in a database 1153 via a network 1152. In addition, if a condition is satisfied, the node device 1102 calls the measurement task 2 of the node device 1103 via the wireless-communication unit 907, under the output condition 1206.

(81) For example, if a blade 1106 of the pump 1101 is damaged and abnormal vibration is occurring, an average value of measurement data in the task 1 exceeds 50.0 m/s², and the threshold determination portion 912 of the output portion 906 determines that the average value has exceeded the threshold (a predetermined condition has been satisfied). If the node device 1102 determines that abnormal vibration is occurring, the node device 1102 sends an instruction to the node device 1103 via the wireless-communication unit 907 for causing the node device 1103 to execute the measurement task 2 for immediately measuring the temperature.

(82) Upon receiving the instruction to execute the measurement task 2, from the node device 1102 via the wireless-communication unit 907, the node device 1103 executes the measurement task 2. The node device 1103 is connected to the temperature sensor attached to the pump 1101. When the measurement task 2 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition 1304: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 1. After the analog-digital conversion, the CPU 905 of the node device 1103 performs the frequency filter process and then the average value process under a signal processing condition 1305. Since

wireless communication is selected under an output processing condition **1306**, the CPU **905** adds a node number **1103** and a task number 2 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to the gateway device **105** via the wireless-communication unit. The gateway device **1151** registers the measurement data, to which the node number **1307 (1103)** and the task number **1302 (2)** have been added, in the database **1153** via the network **1152**.

(83) In the present example, since a call to a task of another node device is set in the output condition, one node device can perform detailed measurement in cooperation with another node device if an error occurs in the pump.

FOURTH EXAMPLE

(84) The fourth example of the present embodiment will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. The following description will be made for a procedure in which when the gateway device receives measurement data from a node device that has been newly installed in a production facility and that has not been registered in the index table of the gateway device, the gateway device stores the measurement data in a database, as test data, separately from normal measurement data.

(85) FIG. **14** illustrates a schematic diagram of an information processing system of the present example. For obtaining the state of a production facility **1401**, a vibration sensor **1404** is disposed in the production facility **1401**, and is connected with a node device **1402**.

(86) For obtaining the detailed state of the production facility **1401**, a temperature sensor **1405** has been newly attached to the production facility **1401**, and a node device **1403** has been newly installed. FIG. **15** illustrates a task table **1501** of the newly installed node device **1403**. In the task table **1501**, a task 1 has been registered in advance. The task 1 is executed under an event condition **1503**, at 15:00 on every Monday.

(87) When the task 1 is executed, the analog-digital conversion is performed under a signal input condition **1504**: an analog-digital conversion channel of 1; a sampling frequency of 54 kHz; an input range from 0 to 5 V; the number of samples of 10,000; and an amplification factor of 1. In the task 1, after the analog-digital conversion, the CPU of the node device **1403** performs the frequency filter process and then the average value process under a signal processing condition **1505**.

(88) As illustrated in FIG. **15**, in the task 1, wireless communication is selected under an output condition **1506**. The CPU adds a node number **1403** and a task number 1 to the measurement data, and sends the measurement data to a gateway device **1451** via the wireless-communication unit **907**.

(89) FIG. **16** illustrates an index table **1601** of the gateway device **1451**. In the index table **1601**, tasks having node numbers **1602** of **1402** and **1450** have been registered in advance. However, the newly installed node device **1403**, illustrated by a dotted line frame in FIG. **16**, has not been registered in the index table **1601**.

(90) FIG. **17** is a flowchart illustrating a flow of processes of the present example. In Step **S71**, the gateway device **1451** starts to obtain the state of the production facility **1401**. In Step **S72**, the gateway device **1451** reads the index table **1601** that has been registered in advance in the storage device **305**.

(91) In Step **S73**, the gateway device **1451** selects a unit to receive measurement data from the node devices **1402**, depending on a receiving unit **1605** registered in the index table **1601**. If a plurality of receiving units **1605** are registered in the index table **1601**, the gateway device **1451** selects the plurality of receiving units **1605**.

(92) In Step **S74**, the gateway device **1451** checks whether one receiving unit **1605** (FIG. **16**) has received measurement data from a node device. If the receiving unit **1605**, which is registered in the index table **1601**, receives measurement data from the node device, the gateway device **1451** proceeds to Step **S75**, and extracts a node number and a task number from the measurement data sent from the node device.

(93) In Step S76, the gateway device **1451** refers to the node number and the task number, and searches the indexes of the index table **1601**. If the gateway device **1451** finds the node number and the task number in the index table **1601**, then the gateway device **1451** proceeds to Step S77 and creates a query, and registers the measurement data, in Step S78, in a database **1453** via a network **1452**. That is, the gateway device **1451** registers the measurement data, to which the node number **1602** (**1402**) and the task number **1603** have been added, in a registration destination identified by a database name **1604** and a table name **1606** of the index table **1601**.

(94) If the gateway device **1451** receives measurement data from the newly installed node device **1403**, the gateway device **1451** cannot find the node number and the task number in Step S76 because they have not been registered in the index table **1601**. In this case, the gateway device **1451** proceeds to Step S79, and creates a query for storing the measurement data in a predetermined measurement-test table of the database. In Step S80, the gateway device **1451** stores the test measurement data in the table of the database **1453** via the in-plant network **1452**. That is, the gateway device **1451** stores the measurement data, to which the unregistered node number and the unregistered task number **1603** have been added, in the registration destination identified by a database name **1604** and a table name **1606** of the index table **1601**.

(95) Note that although the description has been made in the present example for the case where the node number of a node device has not been registered, the measurement data is also handled as test data and registered in the database **1453** if the node number has been registered but the task number has not been registered. That is, the gateway device **1451** registers the measurement data, to which a node number **1602** and an unregistered task number have been added, in a registration destination identified by a database name **1604** and a table name **1606** of the index table **1601**.

(96) In the present example, if the gateway device receives measurement data from a node device that has been newly installed in a production facility or measurement data from a task that has been newly installed on an existing node device, and the newly installed node device or the newly installed task has not been registered in the index table of the gateway device, the gateway device stores the measurement data in a database, as test data, separately from normal measurement data. With this operation, it is possible to check whether the newly installed node device is operating normally, and whether the newly installed task is being performed normally. Note that since the term “test data” is used expediently in the above description, any other term may be used as long as the term means the data related to an unregistered node device or an unregistered task.

Modifications

(97) The present invention is not limited to the above-described embodiments and examples, and can be variously modified within the technical concept of the present invention.

(98) The information processing system of the present invention can be used for monitoring the state of not only the production facility but also various machines and facilities, such as industrial robots, service robots, and processing machines that are numerically controlled by a computer. Mechanical equipment and an information processing device may be combined into the information processing system, or the information processing device may be installed as part of the mechanical equipment.

(99) A method that manufactures products by using a production facility while causing the information processing system of the present invention to obtain the state of the production facility is also included in the embodiments of the present invention. A production facility that includes the information processing system of the present invention is also included in the embodiments of the present invention, as a manufacturing system with a high operating ratio.

(100) The above-described information processing system of the embodiment can be embodied as a system that obtains the state of various facilities including a robot which is operated in a production line, and that monitors the facilities. For example, the facilities are mechanical equipments that can automatically perform expansion and contraction, bending and stretching, up-and-down movement, right-and-left movement, pivot, or combined movement thereof, in accordance with information

stored in the storage device of the control device.

(101) The above-described information processing method (control method) for obtaining the state of a facility, and a computer-readable recording medium that stores a control program that can execute the information processing method (control method) is also included in the embodiments of the present invention. The recording medium for providing the control program may be a ROM, a disk, or an external storage device. Specifically, the computer-readable non-transitory recording medium may be a flexible disk, an optical disk, a magneto-optical disk, a magnetic tape, a nonvolatile memory such as a USB memory, an SSD, or the like.

OTHER EMBODIMENTS

(102) Embodiment(s) of the present invention can also be realized by a computer of a system or apparatus that reads out and executes computer executable instructions (e.g., one or more programs) recorded on a storage medium (which may also be referred to more fully as a ‘non-transitory computer-readable storage medium’) to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or that includes one or more circuits (e.g., application specific integrated circuit (ASIC)) for performing the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s), and by a method performed by the computer of the system or apparatus by, for example, reading out and executing the computer executable instructions from the storage medium to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or controlling the one or more circuits to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s). The computer may comprise one or more processors (e.g., central processing unit (CPU), micro processing unit (MPU)) and may include a network of separate computers or separate processors to read out and execute the computer executable instructions. The computer executable instructions may be provided to the computer, for example, from a network or the storage medium. The storage medium may include, for example, one or more of a hard disk, a random-access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a storage of distributed computing systems, an optical disk (such as a compact disc (CD), digital versatile disc (DVD), or Blu-ray Disc (BD)TM), a flash memory device, a memory card, and the like.

(103) While the present invention has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(104) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-50521, filed Mar. 23, 2020, and Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-179431, filed Oct. 27, 2020, which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

Claims

1. An information processing system comprising: a first device configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility; and a second device configured to communicate with the first device, and storing a first information for identifying an execution condition of the measurement task, the first information associating a second information with the execution condition of the measurement task, wherein the first device sends a measurement data acquired by the sensor in the measurement task and the second information identifying the measurement task to the second device, and wherein the first information includes an index table that associates the second information with the execution condition of the measurement task.
2. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the first device sends the measurement data and a third information identifying the first device to the second device, the first information associating the second information and the third information with the execution condition of the measurement task.
3. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the second information

includes a number assigned to the measurement task.

4. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the second device includes a database configured to store the measurement data.

5. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the second device is configured to set the first information.

6. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the first device is configured to set the execution condition of the measurement task.

7. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the execution condition of the measurement task includes at least one of an event condition regarding timing of executing the measurement task, a signal input condition regarding inputting of a signal in the measurement task, a signal process condition regarding processing of a signal in the measurement task, and a signal output condition regarding outputting of a signal in the measurement task.

8. The information processing system according to claim 1, wherein the first device is a node device, and the second device is a gateway device.

9. An information processing method that uses the information processing system according to claim 1, the information processing method comprising: executing a measurement task using the sensor that measures a state of the facility by the first device; communicating the second device with the first device; and identifying, by the second device, an execution condition of the measurement task based on the first information.

10. A computer-readable non-transitory recording medium storing a control program that causes a computer to execute the information processing method according to claim 9.

11. An information processing system comprising: a first device configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility; and a second device configured to communicate with the first device, and storing a first information for identifying an execution condition of the measurement task, the first information associating a second information with the execution condition of the measurement task, wherein the first device sends a measurement data acquired by the sensor in the measurement task and the second information identifying the measurement task to the second device, and, wherein if the second information received with the measurement data is not present in the first information, the second device creates a query for storing the measurement data.

12. An information processing system comprising: a first device configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility; and a second device configured to communicate with the first device, and storing a first information for identifying an execution condition of the measurement task, wherein the execution condition of the measurement task includes at least one of an event condition regarding timing of executing the measurement task, a signal input condition regarding inputting of a signal in the measurement task, a signal process condition regarding processing of a signal in the measurement task, and a signal output condition regarding outputting of a signal in the measurement task, wherein the event condition includes at least one of a predetermined measurement interval, a time, an external-trigger input signal, a change in the state of the first device, a call from another task of the first device, a call from the second device, and a call from another first device, wherein the signal input condition includes at least one of a physical-quantity input channel, a sampling frequency, an input range, number of samples, and an amplification factor, wherein the signal process condition includes at least one of a no-operation process, an FFT process, a partial overall process, an envelop process, a frequency filter process, a differential process, an integral process, a wavelet process, an average value process, a standard deviation process, a maximum value process, a minimum value process, a peak-to-peak process, a peak hold process, an effective value process, a crest factor process, a form factor process, an impulse coefficient process, a margin coefficient process, and a machine-learning-model inference process, and wherein the signal output condition includes an output destination of a measurement data.

13. A node device comprising: a measurement portion configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility; and a communication portion configured to send a measurement data acquired by the sensor in the measurement task and a second information to a gateway device, the gateway device being configured to communicate with the first device and storing a first information for identifying an execution condition of the measurement task, the first information includes an index table that associates the second information with the execution condition of the measurement task, wherein the second information includes an information corresponding to the execution condition of the measurement task, and wherein the communication portion sends the second information so that the gateway device identifies the execution condition of the measurement task based on the first information stored in the gateway device.
14. A controlling method that uses the node device according to claim 13, the method comprising: executing the measurement task using the sensor that measures a state of the facility; and sending the second information that includes an information corresponding to an execution condition of the measurement task, to the gateway device, so that the gateway device identifies the execution condition of the measurement task based on the first information stored in the gateway device.
15. A gateway device communicating with a node device, wherein the node device is configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility, wherein the gateway device is configured to identify an execution condition of the measurement task based on a first information stored in the gateway device, wherein the gateway device is configured to receive a measurement data acquired by the sensor in the measurement task and a second information identifying the measurement task from the node device, the first information associating the second information with the execution condition of the measurement task, and wherein the first information includes an index table that associates the second information with the execution condition of the measurement task.
16. The gateway device according to claim 15, wherein the gateway device is configured to receive the measurement data and a third information identifying the node device from the node device, the first information associating the second information and the third information with the execution condition of the measurement task.
17. The gateway device according to claim 15, wherein the second information includes a number assigned to the measurement task.
18. The gateway device according to claim 15, wherein the gateway device includes a database configured to store the measurement data.
19. The gateway device according to claim 15, wherein the gateway device is configured to set the first information.
20. A gateway device communicating with a node device, wherein the node device is configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a facility, wherein the gateway device is configured to identify an execution condition of the measurement task based on a first information stored in the gateway device, wherein the gateway device is configured to receive a measurement data acquired by the sensor in the measurement task and a second information identifying the measurement task from the node device, the first information associating the second information with the execution condition of the measurement task, and wherein if the second information received with the measurement data is not present in the first information, the gateway device creates a query for storing the measurement data.
21. A controlling method that uses the gateway device according to claim 20 the method comprising: identifying an execution condition of the measurement task based on the first information stored in the gateway device.
22. A manufacturing system comprising: a node device configured to execute a measurement task using a sensor that measures a state of a manufacturing facility; and the gateway device according to claim 20.
23. A method of manufacturing a product, the method comprising: using the manufacturing system

according to claim 22; and causing the node device to execute the measurement task while causing the manufacturing facility to manufacture a product.
